SPQR is the second volume in the *Great Battles of History Series*. It chronicles and simulates the emergence of the Roman military system and its clashes with—and eventual victories over—the Macedonian system. Whereas the Macedonian system relied on an effective use of combined arms anchored by the strength of the Phalanx and spearheaded by the shock ability of heavy cavalry, the Roman "manipular" legion placed a premium on training and discipline to produce a remarkable tactical flexibility, backed by the defensive ability of the Roman scutum to neutralize the spear and the added killing ability of the infamous Roman sword. However, in terms of "military history" and the art of war, Rome remained a minor, albeit dangerous, military power until the emergence of her first great military mind: Scipio Africanus. Scipio was the first commander to make maximum use of the articulated capabilities of the legion, to understand the importance of cavalry superiority and, most importantly, to break out of the stagnant, break-the-enemy-center tactical thinking of the prior two centuries.